# *3 Kickstart your data mesh MVP in a month*

This chapter covers

- Selecting part of your organization for building your first data products
- Choosing the right people to work on your project
- Setting up the governance of your data mesh
- Discovering and describing your first data product
- Creating the minimal viable infrastructure as a platform (aka the central platform)

In chapter 1, you learned what a data mesh is and what its elements are. In chapter 2, we provided a framework for analysis in terms of whether a data mesh is suitable for you and your business. If you're here, it means you're ready to put that knowledge into practice.

You may use this chapter as a learn-as-you-go experience and, following your Messflix alter-ego example, build your data mesh *minimal viable infrastructure as a platform*, constituting an MVP of your data mesh, within a month. You'll learn how to map your organizational environment and select partners, enabling smooth project development, as well as how to use the most straightforward technical tools to develop a data mesh.

## The minimal mesh

The *mesh*, at its most fundamental, is a graph—in the discrete mathematics understanding of the word. As such, it has two main element categories: nodes and edges.

A *data product*, in this case, can be perceived as a node. The *central platform*, offering the capability of connecting two nodes, forms an edge.

The central platform uses the standardized port of the data product. (Some sources use *data quantum* instead of *data product*, but as *data quantum* comes with its own theory and constraints, to keep our definition simple and inclusive, we intentionally avoid this